



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Visitors savour traditional Emirati cuisine at the Abu Dhabi pavilion on the opening day of Arabian Travel Market at Dubai World Trade Centre yesterday.

Dubai launches unique digital smart card for tourists of determination

Sanad Tourist Card will be issued within 24 hours of a tourist's arrival

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Dubai has launched the world's first digital smart card dedicated to tourists of determination, packed with exclusive privileges, including free services. With the introduction of the innovative Sanad Tourist Card, the Community Development Authority (CDA) in Dubai is providing visiting tourists of determination access to the same benefits offered to people of determination holding the Sanad Card in the city. Maitha Mohammad Al Shamsi, CEO of the Commu-

Tourists can enjoy exceptional experiences, including free access to public transportation such as the Dubai Metro, buses, and ferries.

nity Empowerment Sector at the CDA, said the initiative reaffirms Dubai's vision as a leading inclusive destination for everyone. **'Best city for everyone'** "This is the world's first digital card issued upon arrival for tourists coming to Dubai. Tourists will have access to all the services that people of determination living in Dubai receive. We want to ensure that Dubai is the best city to visit for everyone," Maitha told *Gulf News* on the

sidelines of the Arabian Travel Market. Tourists can enjoy exceptional experiences, including free access to public transportation such as the Dubai Metro, buses, and ferries; free entry or discounts at top tourist attractions like Dubai Parks and Dubai Frame; a special parking permit; a 50 per cent discount on taxi fares; and exclusive discounts at malls, restaurants, pharmacies, and telecom providers. The digital card will be issued within 24 hours of a tourist's arrival in Dubai. Maitha noted that the initiative follows a study conducted in collaboration with the Dubai Economy and Tourism Department. "We have more plans in place to ensure that people of determination have access to all the services they might require during their visits to Dubai."

SEE ALSO P6

HEALTH

Detoxing myths debunked: Does your body really need a juice cleanse? | P7

SPECIAL REPORTS

Private banks cater to Gen Z plus due diligence crucial to avoid fines



INDIA

India bans Pakistani channels in crackdown on social media | P11

Subscribe in print and online
www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00 | Bahrain: BD 0.500 | S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Oman: RO 0.500 | India: RS 40.00 | Pakistan: RS 100.00

Spain, Portugal in the dark after blackout

IMPOSSIBLE TO PREDICT WHEN POWER WILL BE BACK: PORTUGAL OPERATOR

MADRID

Most of Spain and all of Portugal were hit by a major blackout that impacted public transport, power and phone lines at around noon yesterday. The government and grid operator Red Elctrica are seeking to determine the reason for the outage, according to two statements. Backup plans have been put in place by utilities, the Spanish operator said on X. Portugal's grid operator REN said it's also investigating, and that parts of France were also affected. Spain's grid operator said it will take "six to 10 hours" to restore power in Spain. "We are looking at between six and 10 hours, if all goes well," Eduardo Prieto, head of Red Elctrica, told Cadena Sur radio, adding that several parts of the network "are already repaired" and saying it was impossible "to speculate on the cause for the moment".

All resources deployed

Portugal's electricity grid operator said it is still impossible to know how long Portugal will be without power. "At this time it is still impossible to predict when the situation will be normalised," Portuguese operator REN said in a statement, adding it had "all resources deployed" to resolve the blackout. A countrywide blackout is very unusual for any European country, with no event like this in Spain in recent memory. In 2003, Italy saw the worst power cut in more than half a century

2003

Year Italy saw the worst power cut in mainland Europe

when a breakdown of electricity lines from neighbouring countries impacted the whole country, except for the island of Sardinia. London suffered a major outage in 2019. The event yesterday left authorities unable to explain the causes of the outage at least an hour after it occurred. A crisis committee has been set up in Spain to manage the situation, according to people familiar to the situation. At this stage there's no evidence yet regarding the cause of the massive blackout. A cyber attack has not been ruled out and investigations are ongoing. Public transport, traffic lights and phone services were mostly down in parts of Madrid, Barcelona and Lisbon due to the outage, while trains were mostly halted. Companies in Spain sent workers home and the streets of major cities quickly filled with people, with police controlling traffic. In Madrid, the metro was evacuated and office workers filled the pathways of the city's financial district, while ambulances raced through the main thoroughfare Castellana avenue, where traffic agents used speakers on cars to direct cars and people. ATMs in the city centre were not working. — Agencies



HAPPY Akshaya Tritiya

Joyalukkas Golden Prosperity

24K

FREE

500 MG 24K GOLD BAR

ON PURCHASE OF DIAMOND & PRECIOUS STONE JEWELLERY WORTH AED 3,500

24K

FREE

1 GM 24K GOLD BAR OR LAKSHMI IDOL

ON PURCHASE OF DIAMOND & PRECIOUS STONE JEWELLERY WORTH AED 6,000 & GOLD JEWELLERY PURCHASE WORTH AED 20,000

24K

FREE

10 GM 24K GOLD BAR

ON PURCHASE OF DIAMOND & PRECIOUS STONE JEWELLERY WORTH AED 50,000

200 MG (22K) GOLD COIN

ON PURCHASE OF GOLD JEWELLERY WORTH AED 3500 (Offer valid only on 30th April 2025)

NO MAKING CHARGES ON 8GM GOLD COINS

0% DEDUCTION ON OLD GOLD EXCHANGE

SILVER COINS AVAILABLE AT ALL UAE OUTLETS



SCAN FOR LATEST JEWELLERY COLLECTION

OFFER VALID UNTIL 4TH MAY 2025

Joyalukkas
World's favourite jeweller

UAE • OMAN • QATAR • BAHRAIN • KUWAIT • KSA • SINGAPORE • MALAYSIA • UK • USA • INDIA

*Conditions apply / Not applicable for Gold Bars, Gold coins & 24K Jewellery